

Tide Benefit Cards Internal Launch Plan: Phased Rollout and Pilot Testing Strategy

Tide Benefit Cards - Internal Launch Plan

Executive Summary

This document outlines the phased rollout approach for Tide Benefit Cards, starting with an internal pilot with Tide employees before launching to external corporates. The phased approach allows us to validate functionality, identify edge cases, and refine the product experience in a controlled environment.

Strategic Rationale

Why Start Internal:

- Validate core functionality with a controlled user group
- Identify and resolve issues before external launch
- Gather real-world feedback from engaged users
- Build confidence in the product with our own team before market launch
- Minimize reputational risk with external corporates

Product Limitations - Slice 1

Limitation 1: No Wallet Fallback Mechanism

Current Behavior: Benefit cards are linked to multiple wallets:

- Food/Meal wallet
- Telecom wallet
- Fuel wallet
- Rewards wallet
- General account

Each benefit wallet (except rewards and general) is mapped to specific MCC codes. When a transaction is initiated:

- The system checks **only** the primary mapped wallet for that MCC
- Transaction is **rejected if insufficient funds exist** in that specific wallet

- This occurs **even when other wallets contain adequate balance**

Example:

- Employee attempts food purchase (food MCC) for ₹500
- Food wallet balance: ₹200
- General account balance: ₹5,000
- **Result:** Transaction declined despite ₹5,200 total available balance

Impact:

- Suboptimal user experience
- Potential transaction declines despite adequate overall funds
- Requires employees to manually monitor individual wallet balances

Limitation 2: Manual Reimbursement Process

Current State:

- Reimbursement claims must be handled manually
- No automated reimbursement flow via app
- Due to Limitation #1, general wallet balance can only be used in limited scenarios
- Rewards wallet cannot be offered at this stage

Impact:

- Administrative overhead for employees and HR/Finance teams
- Slower reimbursement processing
- Limited utility of general wallet funds

Phased Rollout Plan

Phase 1: Controlled Pilot (Slice 1) - December 2024

Objectives:

- Validate core benefit card functionality
- Test multi-wallet transaction flows
- Identify edge cases and user pain points
- Gather feedback on user experience with known limitations

Target Audience:

- **Total eligible employees:** ~250
- **Target participation:** 100+ employees
- **Selection criteria:** Volunteers who acknowledge and accept current limitations

Key Activities:

1. Employee Communication & Consent (Week 1)

- Send detailed communication to all eligible employees explaining:
 - Benefit cards features and benefits
 - Current limitations (Slice 1)
 - Expectations for pilot participation
 - Explicit consent requirement acknowledging limitations
- Highlight this is a pilot/testing phase
- Create sign-up form with consent acknowledgment

Consent Language (as recommended by Risk & Compliance):

"I understand that this is a pilot version of Tide Benefit Cards with certain limitations, including the lack of wallet fallback mechanism and manual reimbursement process. I voluntarily agree to participate in testing and provide feedback. I acknowledge that my existing Sodexo card will remain active for managing pending balances and rewards benefits during this pilot phase."

2. Parallel Systems (Throughout Phase 1)

- Pilot employees retain their existing Sodexo cards for:
 - Using pending balances from previous months
 - Accessing rewards benefits (as rewards wallet not available in Slice 1)
- Sodexo cards remain active throughout Phase 1

3. Onboarding & Activation (Week 2-3)

- Issue Tide Benefit Cards to consenting employees
- Provide onboarding materials and user guides
- Set up support channels for pilot participants
- Load initial benefit allocations into respective wallets

4. Monitoring & Feedback (Week 3 onwards)

- Daily transaction monitoring
- Weekly feedback sessions with pilot users
- Track key metrics:

- Transaction success/decline rates by wallet type
- Common user issues and pain points
- Support ticket volume and categories
- User satisfaction scores

5. **Iteration & Refinement (Ongoing)**

- Address critical bugs and issues
- Refine user experience based on feedback
- Document learnings for Slice 2 development

6. **EOY report** - Phase 1 Benefit txn data will not be available in the EOY report that gets automated in Phase 2. We will have to populate this data set manually in the EOY report

Success Criteria:

- 100+ employees successfully onboarded
- Transaction success rate >85%
- No critical compliance or regulatory issues
- Positive user feedback (NPS >30)
- Clear documentation of improvement areas for Slice 2

Risk Mitigation:

- **RBI Complaint Risk:** Explicit consent from all pilot participants acknowledging limitations
- **User Dissatisfaction:** Clear communication of pilot nature and limitations upfront
- **Dual System Complexity:** Clear guidance on when to use Tide vs. Sodexo cards
- **Support Overwhelm:** Dedicated support channel for pilot users

Phase 2: Enhanced Pilot (Slice 2) - February-March 2025

Objectives:

- Test wallet fallback mechanism with remaining employees
- Validate automated reimbursement flows
- Test year-end reporting capabilities
- Validate bulk lead registration process

Key Enhancements (Slice 2):

1. **Wallet Fallback Mechanism (Live: End of February)**

- Automatic fallback to general account when benefit wallet has insufficient funds

- Seamless transaction experience across wallets
- Reduced transaction declines

2. **Automated Reimbursement via App**

- In-app reimbursement claim submission
- Automated approval workflows
- Digital receipt uploads
- Real-time reimbursement tracking

3. **Year-End Reporting**

- Automated tax-related reports
- Wallet-wise spending summaries
- Compliance documentation

4. **Bulk Lead Registration**

- Streamlined process for adding multiple employees
- CSV upload capability
- Automated account creation and card issuance

Target Audience:

- **Remaining Tide employees:** ~150 (not part of Phase 1 pilot)
- **Existing pilot users:** 100 (for testing new features)

Key Activities:

1. **Feature Rollout (End of February)**

- Deploy wallet fallback mechanism
- Release automated reimbursement module
- Enable year-end reporting features
- Activate bulk registration capability

2. **Pilot Group Expansion (Early March)**

- Onboard remaining 150 employees with full Slice 2 capabilities
- Migrate Phase 1 pilot users to Slice 2 features
- Prepare for complete Sodexo transition

3. **Comprehensive Testing (March)**

- Test all fallback scenarios across wallet types
- Process reimbursement claims end-to-end via app

- Generate and validate year-end reports
- Test bulk employee onboarding flows
- Validate rewards wallet functionality

4. External Launch Preparation

- Finalize marketing collateral
- Prepare sales enablement materials
- Document implementation process for corporate clients
- Train customer success team
- Establish support processes and escalation paths

Success Criteria:

- Wallet fallback mechanism working with >95% accuracy
- Reimbursement processing time <2 business days
- Year-end reports generated without errors
- Bulk registration successfully tested with 50+ employees
- All 150 employees successfully transitioned from Sodexo to Tide
- User satisfaction NPS >50

Phase 3: General Availability - April 2025

Objectives:

- Launch Tide Benefit Cards to external corporate clients
- Scale product to market
- Establish Tide as competitive player in benefit cards space

Target Audience:

- External corporates (SMEs and larger enterprises)
- Companies seeking flexible benefit card solutions

Key Activities:

1. Go-to-Market Launch (April)

- Official product announcement
- Marketing campaign activation
- Sales team enablement
- Partnership outreach (HR tech platforms, payroll providers)

2. **Client Onboarding**

- Pilot client acquisitions (5-10 companies)
- White-glove onboarding support
- Success metrics tracking
- Case study development

3. **Continuous Improvement**

- Regular product iterations based on client feedback
- Feature enhancements based on market demands
- Expansion to additional benefit categories
- Integration with third-party systems (HRMS, payroll)

Success Criteria:

- 10+ corporate clients onboarded in first quarter
- Product-market fit validated
- Positive client testimonials and case studies
- Scalable operations established

Timeline Overview

Phase	Duration	Key Milestones	Audience
Phase 1: Slice 1 Pilot	Dec 2024 - Jan 2025	Employee consent, 100+ onboarded, feedback gathered	100 Tide employees
Phase 2: Slice 2 Pilot	Feb - Mar 2025	Fallback mechanism live, remaining employees onboarded, full testing / Phase out Sodexo	All 250 Tide employees

Phase 3: GA Launch	April 2025	External corporate launch, client acquisition	External corporates
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Next Steps

Immediate Actions (Week of 24th Nov):

1. Finalize consent language with Risk & Compliance team
2. Draft employee communication and sign-up form
3. Confirm engineering readiness for December launch
4. Set up pilot support infrastructure

Week 1 Actions:

1. Send pilot invitation to all eligible employees
2. Launch sign-up form and track responses
3. Conduct employee Q&A sessions
4. Begin card production for pilot participants

Week 2 Actions:

1. Close sign-ups and finalize pilot cohort
2. Issue cards and begin onboarding
3. Load initial benefit allocations
4. Activate support channels